Why Your AI Edits Look Like Trash (3 Fixes)

Channel: Brandon Carter · Published: Oct 21, 2026 · Watch: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/rra_tHXvTxw Source: full transcript

📋 Executive Summary

Brandon Carter shares three techniques for getting polished AI-edited videos using Claude: reference-style prompting, preview-based iteration, and saving a reusable named "skill" to trigger your whole editing style in three words.

📑 Contents

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🎬 Context: Claude-Edited Videos 0:00

- Brandon claims Claude edited multiple reels shown on screen
- States that most people's AI-edited videos "come out looking like trash"
- Promises three specific fixes that make his edits "come out fire"
- Teases that Fix 3 lets him edit a whole reel by saying just **three words**

🖼️ Fix 1: Show It, Don't Tell It 0:09

- The core mistake: giving vague text prompts like "make this look cool"
  - Claude (or any AI) has no reference point for your aesthetic when given abstract instructions
- The fix: send Claude an actual reel in the style you want to replicate
  - Then prompt: "Edit my reel just like this"
- What Claude copies from the reference:
  - The cuts (edit rhythm and timing)
  - The pacing (how fast or slow segments move)
  - The captions (style, placement, timing of text overlays)
- It then applies all of those elements to your own footage

👁️ Fix 2: Never Let It Work Blind 0:25

- Don't let Claude produce a finished edit without checkpoints
- **Make it show you previews first** so you can give feedback before the full output is locked in
- Expect some back-and-forth on the first attempt
  - You may need to go back and forth with Claude "a few times" initially
  - This iterative loop is normal and expected — it's how you dial in the result

💾 Fix 3: Save Your Style as a Skill 0=38

- Trigger condition: once a video comes out **exactly** how you want it
- Action: tell Claude to "save it as a skill"
  - Give the skill a memorable name — Brandon's example: **"YAP style edit"**
- How to use it going forward:
  - Dump your raw footage into Claude
  - Type the skill name (e.g., "YAP style edit") — just three words
  - Claude applies the entire saved editing style automatically
- Meta-confirmation: Brandon states this video itself was made using exactly that method

> The skill-saving trick is the compounding payoff — you do the hard iterative work once, then replicate your best edit style indefinitely with a three-word prompt.